

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 6, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 12:21–31

21 And the eye cannot say to the hand, "I have no need of you"; nor again the head to the feet, "I have no need of you."

22 No, much rather, those members of the body which seem to be weaker are necessary.

23 And those members of the body which we think to be less honorable, on these we bestow greater honor; and our unpresentable parts have greater modesty,

24 but our presentable parts have no need. But God composed the body, having given greater honor to that part which lacks it,

25 that there should be no schism in the body, but that the members should have the same care for one another.

26 And if one member suffers, all the members suffer with it; or if one member is honored, all the members rejoice with it.

27 Now you are the body of Christ, and members individually.

28 And God has appointed these in the church: first apostles, second prophets, third teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, administrations, varieties of tongues.

29 Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Are all workers of miracles?

30 Do all have gifts of healings? Do all speak with tongues? Do all interpret?

31 But earnestly desire the best gifts. And yet I show you a more excellent way.

II. Key Summary

- Paul argues that every part of the body is mutually dependent: the eye cannot say to the hand "I have no need of you," and the members that seem weaker are in fact

necessary; God has given greater honor to the parts that lack it (vv. 21–24).

- God designed the body so that members care for one another and share in both suffering and joy — when one member suffers, all suffer; when one is honored, all rejoice (vv. 25–26).

- Paul lists the various roles God has appointed in the church, notes that not everyone has the same gift, and calls believers to earnestly desire the best gifts, promising to show them "a more excellent way" (vv. 27–31).

III. Passage Analysis

The Hands You Don't Notice Are Holding Up What You Think You Did Alone

"Even the most talented cannot function without the aid and cooperation of those of more humble attainments." [1]

The "eye" in Paul's metaphor represents the visible, insightful, gifted members of a community. The "hand" represents those quietly executing the background work. Paul's point isn't just a call to humility — it's a structural truth: without the people doing the invisible work, the "gifted" can't actually do anything.

Someone Else's Pain Is Your Problem Too

"All Christians are dependent one upon another; each is to expect and receive help from the rest." [2]

The Corinthians had turned spiritual gifts into a ranking system. Paul cuts that off entirely — a body doesn't have a ranking system, it has a nervous system. When one part hurts, the whole body responds. That's not just a nice sentiment; it's the actual design Paul is describing.

IV. Reflection Question

In any group you're part of — your class, a church small group, a club, a part-time job — is there someone who mostly flies under the radar, and then one time they were absent, or their usual task just didn't get done, and you suddenly noticed something felt off? Did it

cross your mind in that moment that they'd been doing that all along?

If God specifically gives greater honor to the parts that seem least impressive, how do you think He sees that person you usually don't notice?

References

[1] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/12-21.htm

[2] BibleHub, Matthew Henry's Concise Commentary,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/12-25.htm